Can one

SENTENCE

change your life?

1 · DESCRIBE

3
hours

WHO

Nelson Mandela

WHEN

20 April 1964

WHERE

Rivonia Trial, from the dock



2 · CONTEXT

APARTHEID

Racist laws.

Unequal rights.

Photo: Mandela burning his pass, 1960. Public domain, Wikimedia Commons. Converted to black and white.

3 • EXPLAIN

His ideal

DEMOCRACY
EQUALITY
HARMONY

an ideal

3 · EXPLAIN · THE LAST SENTENCE

It is an ideal

Nelson Mandela · 20 April 1964

3 · EXPLAIN · THE LAST SENTENCE

It is an ideal for which

Nelson Mandela · 20 April 1964

3 · EXPLAIN · THE LAST SENTENCE

It is an ideal for which I am prepared

Nelson Mandela · 20 April 1964

3 · EXPLAIN · THE LAST SENTENCE

It is an ideal for which I am prepared to die.

Nelson Mandela · 20 April 1964

Three tools



IF NEEDS BE

he added it to the last sentence



REPETITION

I have fought against…
I have fought against…



CALM

“a calm and sober assessment”

5 · LINK

One word, two meanings

WORDS

His last
SENTENCE

→

THE RISK

A death
SENTENCE?

→

THE RESULT

A life
SENTENCE

5 · LINK

WORDS

vs

POWER

He “dared” the judge.



Photo: Mandela's cell, Robben Island. © Schavda, CC BY-SA 3.0, Wikimedia Commons. Converted to black and white.

Why this speech?

1. Life or death: real stakes
2. One man vs. a whole system
3. 27 years later: president

And for me…

CONCLUSION

Words can control.

Words can FREE.

Which ideal would you speak up for?

SOURCES · NOT PRESENTED

Speech facts: Wikipedia, “I Am Prepared to Die” (CC BY-SA 4.0).

Speech text: famous-trials.com, “I Am Prepared To Die”; Nelson Mandela Foundation / mandela.gov.za.

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Both photos converted to black and white. No AI-generated images.